



Troubleshooting

PC fatigue? Plagued by viruses? Troubled by slow system response? Here's the end to your PC woes

Hardware

+ Upgrading RAM

I have an assembled Celeron 366 MHz system with 32 MB SDRAM and Windows 98 SE. My computer is working very slowly, so I have decided to increase the RAM size. What are the technical specifications I have to take note of before buying the RAM? How much RAM does my motherboard support? I don't know which company manufactures this motherboard, but with the help of a BIOS string (BIOS ID - 09/03/1999-i810-ITE8712-6A69MSMDC-00) I found that my motherboard uses the Intel i810e chipset.

Anantha Narayanan. N

Via e-mail

R As you have a Celeron processor, your system is running at 66 MHz FSB (Front Side Bus). As most new RAM modules that are available in the market today are specified at 133 MHz or higher and are also backward compatible, you need not worry whether the RAM you purchase will be compatible with your machine or not.

With regards to your second query, the Intel 810e chipset motherboard supports a maximum of 512 MB PC-133 RAM.

Windows

+ Of restore folders

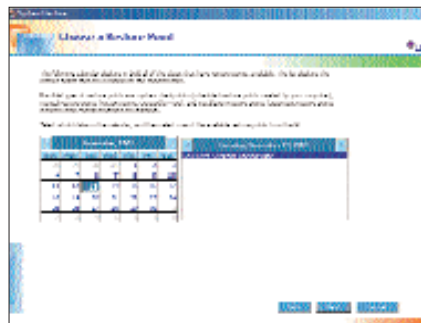
I have a P-III machine with 128 MB RAM, a 20 GB hard disk drive and Windows Me as the operating system.

1. Whenever I create a restore point in System Restore, the space in the _restore folder (C:_restore) increases abnormally and its size increases to nearly 500 MB. After some time all my previous restore points are lost. The space allocated for System Restore is maximum. Once I tried to restore my computer to an earlier time and it said restoration was unsuccessful, and the size of the _restore folder increased to 1 GB. After that I had to disable the system restore to get back the original size of the folder, but all my earlier restore points were lost. Please send me an appropriate solution for this.

P.S. The size of the _restore folder keeps fluctuating in the range of 500 MB to 1 GB.

Hemesh Kumar Soni

Via e-mail



The System Restore function in Win Me

R The System Restore facility provided in Windows Me and Windows XP does take up a lot of space, hence this should not worry you. Moreover, System Restore also wipes out the 'old restore' points it has created when it exceeds the maximum available space allocated to it. If you think that too much of your hard disk space is being occupied, you can disable System Restore by going to System Properties.

Windows

+ A FAT problem

I have a Pentium 200 MMX processor, 32 MB RAM and Windows Me installed in my PC. How can I convert my file system from FAT16 to FAT32 without formatting the hard disk?

Saurabh

Via e-mail

R To convert your drive to the FAT32 file system, go to Control Panel > Add/Remove programs > Windows Startup disk. Insert a floppy and create a bootable Startup disk. Reboot your computer using this Startup disk.

In case you are unable to boot the computer, check whether the boot sequence on the computer is configured properly. Restart your computer and in the BIOS,

select A: as the first option for the device you would like to boot from.

In the Startup disk menu options, select the option to start your computer without CD-ROM support. Type `cvt drive:` at the command prompt. Here 'drive' is the drive that you want to convert to the FAT32 file system. The Cvt.exe file is actually located in the C:\Windows\Command folder and Startup disk automatically sets this as the path for the Cvt.exe file. If Windows is not installed in this folder and you receive a bad command or file name error message, type `drive:\windows_folder\command\ cvt.exe drive2` at a command prompt, where 'drive' is the drive in which Windows is installed, 'windows_folder' is the Windows folder and 'drive2' is the drive that you want to convert.

Press [Enter] to finish conversion to FAT32. Remove the Startup disk from your floppy drive and restart your computer when prompted.

Internet & Communications

+ A lethargic mouse

I'm using a PC with a P-III 733 MHz processor and 192 MB RAM, running on Windows 98 SE. It usually happens that initially my system is very pacy and things run fast but when I am on the Net for more than an hour, the right mouse button stops functioning in Internet Explorer (Save Image as). It only resumes after I close a few IE windows. My mouse starts behaving very sluggishly and the system gets slower with the applications taking longer to open or close. It regains its speed only after I restart the system.

Najmul

Via e-mail

R Older versions of Internet Explorer are known to occupy memory without refreshing itself, hence you find that the machine becomes sluggish after some time. To overcome this, you should update your browser to the latest version, which can either be obtained from the Digit Mindware CD or can also be downloaded from the Microsoft site. If you still find no